Her way of dealing with attacks on me was to get in a hot bath and hold an imaginary conversation with whoever had taken after me that day—she'd just talk to the wall and get it off her chest.

I wish I had been able to find as easy a way to deal with attacks on her. In some ways Nancy and I are like one human being: When one of us has a problem, it automatically becomes a problem for the other; an attack on one of us is an attack on both of us. When one suffers, so does the other.

Over the years, I've often felt guilty that so much flak meant for me was aimed at her. When somebody would say something untruthful or nasty about Nancy and I'd get upset about it, people would tell me, "Oh, that's just politics."

Well, I never agreed with that or got used to it. There is no justification for a political opponent or someone in the press to go after a man's wife just because he is in politics.

During those first few months in Sacramento, Nancy began to realize that being the wife of a man in public life could bring with it the unwanted role of serving as a target of potshots meant for him; but it wasn't easy for her, and it never would be. I know it never became any easier for me.

We hadn't been in Sacramento for more than a few months when I came home one day and told Nancy: "I spent thirteen years at Warner Brothers and they couldn't give me an ulcer, but I think I'm getting one now."

I'd felt a sharp pain down in my stomach that wouldn't go away. When I told Nancy's father and brother, who was also a doctor, about it, they agreed it sounded like an ulcer, then my regular physician confirmed the diagnosis.

I'm not sure when I started to get the ulcer; it's possible it started when I first came under that pressure to run for governor, when I couldn't get people to take no for an answer. Whatever its origins, my battles with the legislature, the continuing upheaval on our campuses, and the other